



Q.12) "The recurring famines of the nineteenth century were the inevitable consequence of the deindustrialization process of the Indian economy under British rule."

Critically evaluate.

(15 Marks, 250 Words)

"उन्नीसवीं शताब्दी में आये क्रमिक अकाल, ब्रिटिश शासन अंतर्गत भारतीय अर्थव्यवस्था की विखंडन प्रक्रिया का अपरिहार्य परिणाम थे।" मूल्यांकन करें।

(15 अंक, 250 शब्द)

The Indian economy underwent deindustrialisation process under British rule to be converted to supplier of raw material & market for finished goods.

De-industrialisation process

Heavy tariffs on Indian produce entering
Countries

↓
Reduced tariffs on imported British
Goods.

↓
Sourcing of raw materials across
India through Rail & Road.

↓
Indian Industries became unviable
and had to shut down

↓
Reverse migration of people towards
rural area & agriculture.

De-industrialisation led to famines

- Due to the demand for raw materials there was increased commercialisation of agriculture.
- Cash crops like opium, spices, indigo replaced the food grains production as farmers were forced to produce them.
- This created acute shortage in food grains across India leading to famines, also due to unaffordability.
- Commercialisation also meant profit mentality leading to hoarding of crops creating artificial shortage further aggravated famines.
eg. Odisha famine of 1867.
- The de-industrialisation also meant only finished goods were imported to India, thus food grain shortage was

not managed by imports as well.

However, many other reasons also aggravated famine conditions in 19th Century :

1. Climatic conditions of drought
2. Lack of investment in agriculture leading to stagnant production
3. Transport system was not used to supply smoothly food grains across India.
4. Economic conditions of people was poor leading to inherent unaffordability
5. British extravagance in India during famines led to mismanagement.

British appointed many committees in 19th Century eg. Lyall, McDowell, etc. to ensure that such conditions can be controlled as it affected their grains as well.

Feedback (For OFFICE use only)

Structure		Content	
Question Interpretation		Total :	